Grass Cutter



Category: **Agriculture & Gardening** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Grass cutter

What it is used for

To cut grass and light vegetation using a powered grass cutter. To achieve an even cut while keeping the operator and nearby people clear of the cutting zone.

Main parts

- Engine or electric motor
- Cutting blade or trimmer head
- Guard and deflector
- Handle and throttle or speed control
- Shaft and drive mechanism
- Harness, switch, and power connection as applicable

Before you start

1. Read the operating manual and identify the correct cutting attachment for the task.
2. Inspect the blade or trimmer head, guard, handle, shaft, and fasteners for damage.
3. For electric models, inspect the cable, plug, battery, and connectors; for fuel models, check fuel and leaks.
4. Confirm that the cutting attachment is securely fitted and suitable for the machine.
5. Remove stones, wire, glass, and other objects from the cutting area.
6. Wear eye and face protection, hearing protection, sturdy footwear, long trousers, and gloves as recommended.

How to use

1. Place the cutter on stable ground in a clear starting area.
2. For a petrol model, follow the manual's starting procedure; for an electric model, connect the power source safely.
3. Keep the cutting head clear of the ground and people when starting.
4. Hold the machine firmly with both hands or use the prescribed harness and grip.
5. Start the cutter and allow it to reach the appropriate operating speed.
6. Cut grass in controlled, overlapping passes without forcing the cutting head.
7. Maintain a safe distance from people, animals, vehicles, windows, and fragile objects.
8. Stop and isolate the machine before clearing wrapped grass or checking the cutting head.
9. Switch off the engine or disconnect the battery or power source before changing attachments.
10. After work, allow hot components to cool and remove grass debris using a safe method.
11. Inspect the cutting attachment for wear or damage before storage.

2. Store the cutter with its blade guarded in a dry, secure place.

⚠ Safety

- Keep bystanders well away from the cutting area and the direction of thrown debris.
- Never remove or modify the cutting guard.
- Do not operate with a damaged blade, loose head, or faulty switch.
- Avoid cutting in wet, slippery conditions or near hidden cables and pipes.
- Keep hands and feet away from the cutting head and never touch it while moving.
- Refuel petrol models only when switched off and cool, away from flames or sparks.
- Disconnect electrical power or remove the battery before maintenance.

Care & storage

- Clean grass and dirt from the guard, shaft, and air vents after use.
- Inspect and sharpen or replace blades only as directed by the manufacturer.
- Check fasteners, handles, harness, and safety switch regularly.
- Maintain the engine, battery, or power cable according to the model's manual.
- Store fuel safely and keep the machine protected from moisture.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Operating without the required guard or protective equipment.
- Using the wrong blade or an attachment that is not securely fitted.
- Cutting too close to people or hard objects that can throw debris.
- Clearing tangled grass while the cutting head can still move.
- Refuelling while the engine is hot or leaving the machine connected during maintenance.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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